Ingredient	Key Nutrients	Meal Ideas
Eggs	Protein, choline, vitamin D	Breakfast, fried rice, sandwiches, salads, snacks
Oats	Fiber, iron, magnesium	Oatmeal, smoothies, pancakes, muffins, granola
Quinoa	Complete plant protein, fiber, iron, magnesium	Power bowls, grain bowls, salads, soups
Sweet potatoes	Vitamin A, fiber, potassium	Roasted, mashed, fries, soups
Potatoes	Potassium, vitamin C	Mash, stew, baked, breakfast hash
Whole wheat bread	Fiber, B vitamins	Toast, sandwiches, French toast
Whole wheat pasta	Fiber, energy	Pasta dishes, pasta salad
Beans (black, kidney, pinto)	Protein, iron, folate	Chili, soups, tacos, salads
Lentils	Protein, iron, folate	Curries, soups, stews
Chickpeas	Protein, fiber	Hummus, salads, curries, roasted snacks
Greek yogurt	Protein, calcium, probiotics	Breakfast, smoothies, dips, snacks
Milk (or fortified soy milk)	Calcium, vitamin D, protein	Cereal, smoothies, sauces
Cheese	Calcium, protein	Sandwiches, eggs, pasta
Peanut butter	Healthy fats, protein	Toast, oatmeal, smoothies, apples

Canned tuna (low-mercury varieties)	Protein, omega-3	Sandwiches, salads, pasta
Canned salmon	Calcium, vitamin D, omega-3	Patties, rice bowls, salads
Chicken thighs	Protein, iron	Stir-fries, soups, wraps
Ground turkey	Lean protein	Meatballs, tacos, pasta sauce
Frozen mixed vegetables	Vitamins, fiber	Stir-fries, soups, fried rice
Spinach (fresh or frozen)	Iron, folate	Omelets, smoothies, pasta, soups
Broccoli	Vitamin C, calcium, fiber	Roasted, pasta, casseroles
Carrots	Vitamin A	Soups, snacks, roasting
Bell peppers	Vitamin C	Stir-fries, salads, wraps
Onions	Antioxidants	Nearly every savory meal
Garlic	Flavor, antioxidants	Soups, sauces, vegetables
Tomatoes (fresh or canned)	Lycopene, vitamin C	Pasta sauce, soups, stews
Bananas	Potassium	Smoothies, oatmeal, snacks
Apples	Fiber	Snacks, oatmeal, baking
Frozen berries	Vitamin C, antioxidants	Smoothies, yogurt, oatmeal
Avocados	Healthy fats, folate	Toast, salads, wraps

Affordable pantry staples

These make meals flavorful and nutritious while lasting a long time:

- Olive oil
- Canola oil
- Iodized salt (important source of iodine)
- Black pepper
- Paprika
- Turmeric
- Cumin
- Cinnamon
- Dried herbs (oregano, thyme, basil)
- Low-sodium chicken or vegetable broth
- Tomato paste
- Soy sauce (reduced sodium)
- Vinegar (apple cider or white)
- Honey

Healthy snack ingredients

These work well for both pregnancy and breastfeeding when extra calories and nutrients are needed:

- Mixed nuts (unsalted)
- Pumpkin seeds
- Sunflower seeds
- Raisins
- Dates
- Air-popped popcorn kernels
- Whole grain crackers
- Hummus
- Cottage cheese
- Fresh fruit

Why these ingredients?

Together, these foods help provide:

- **Protein:** eggs, chicken, yogurt, beans, lentils, fish
- **Iron:** lentils, beans, spinach, fortified oats, meat
- **Calcium:** milk, yogurt, cheese, canned salmon
- **Folate:** spinach, lentils, chickpeas, beans
- **Choline:** eggs (especially important during pregnancy)
- **Healthy fats & omega-3s:** salmon, tuna, peanut butter, avocado
- **Fiber:** oats, beans, fruits, vegetables, whole grains
- **Vitamin A:** sweet potatoes, carrots
- **Vitamin C:** peppers, broccoli, berries, tomatoes
- **Iodine:** iodized salt, dairy, eggs, fish